

YANG, XUETING

Department of Economics and Related Studies, University of York, York, YO10 5DD

Personal Website: xuetiing97131.github.io

Mobile: +447827189585 | Email: xuetiing.yang@york.ac.uk

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Experimental and Behavioural Economics, with a focus on decision-making under risk and ambiguity, consumer behaviour, and applied microeconomic theory.

TEACHING INTERESTS

Microeconomics, Behavioural Economics, Experimental Economics

RESEARCH AGENDA

My research lies in experimental and behavioural economics, focusing on decision-making under risk and ambiguity. I develop a coherent research programme across three main streams:

- Probability misperception in consumer behaviour
- Complexity and cognitive constraints in ambiguous decision-making
- Applications to labour contracts and insurance markets

Going forward, I aim to extend this work to policy-relevant and applied settings, while continuing to use experimental methods to test and compare theoretical models of decision-making.

EDUCATION

09/2023 – 2026 (Expected) University of York, Department of Economics and Related Studies York, UK

Ph.D., Economics

Dissertation: *Individual decision-making in ambiguous (and risky) situations*

09/2020 – 03/2022 Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, International Business School Suzhou Suzhou, China

MSc, Economics and Finance (with Distinction)

09/2015 – 06/2019 Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, International Business School Suzhou Suzhou, China

BSc, Economics and Finance (with British First-class Degree)

PUBLICATION

Yang, X., & Hey, J. (2025). **Do workers maximize expected utility when choosing labour contracts under ambiguity?** *Journal of Risk and Uncertainty*, 71(3), 273–292. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11166-025-09470-w>

WORKING PAPERS

- **Probability Misperception in Blind Box Consumption: An Experimental Investigation of Risk and Ambiguity Preferences** (*submitted*)

Uses laboratory experiments (BDM mechanism) to test whether consumers overestimate low-probability outcomes. Results show systematic overestimation, particularly among risk-seeking individuals, suggesting that demand for blind boxes is driven by probability misperception rather than ambiguity preferences.

- **Does increasing complexity change behaviour under ambiguity? “Less is More” (*Job market paper*)**

Examines how complexity affects decision-making under ambiguity. Experimental evidence shows that increased complexity leads to noisier behaviour and improves the relative performance of simpler models (EU), while more complex models overfit decision noise.

CONFERENCES & PRESENTATIONS

- 06/2026 *ASFEE 2026: Annual Conference of the French Association of Experimental Economics*, Lille, France. (Oral Presentation)
- 06/2026 *2026 CMID (conference on Mechanism and Institution Design)*, York, UK. (Member of local organization committee)
- 06/2026 *FUR (Foundations of Utility and Risk) Conference 2026*, Alicante, Spain. (Oral Presentation)
- 03/2026 *ECO Department Brownbag Seminar*, Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, Suzhou, China. (Seminar Talker)
- 10/2025 *Departmental Thursday Workshop*, University of York, York, UK. (Presenter)
- 06/2025 *ASFEE 2025: 15th Conference of the French Experimental Economics Association*, Nancy, France. (Oral Presentation & Poster session)
- 06/2025 *ESA 2025 World Meeting*, Beijing, China. (Oral Presentation)
- 08/2024 *2024 SABE/IAREP Conference*, Dundee, UK. (Poster Session)

AWARDS & FUNDING

- *Departmental PhD Studentship Funding*, University of York, 2023-2027
- *Teaching Excellence Award*, University of York, 2025

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of York, Department of Economics and Related Studies

York, UK

Teaching Assistant

Microeconomic Theory (Undergraduate), 09/2024 – 02/2026

- Led tutorial sessions, explaining core microeconomic concepts and guiding students through problem-solving exercises
- Supported students in developing analytical and mathematical reasoning skills
- Provided detailed feedback on assignments and assessments

Probability and Statistics (Undergraduate), 02/2025 – 06/2025

- Delivered small-group teaching sessions, assisting students in understanding probability theory and statistical methods
- Helped students apply theoretical concepts to practical problems

Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, International Business School Suzhou

Suzhou, China

Teaching Assistant

Experimental Economics and Finance (Undergraduate), 09/2021 – 12/2021

- Assisted in delivering experimental economics sessions, including supporting classroom experiments
- Facilitated student engagement and discussion in interactive learning environments
- Adapted teaching approach to support students with diverse academic backgrounds

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Student Development Advise Officer (Full-time), 05/2022-05/2023

- Provided one-to-one guidance to students on personal, social, and campus-related challenges
- Supported student wellbeing and adjustment within an international university environment
- Handled urgent student issues and coordinated with relevant university services
- Organised and delivered student development activities and campus events
- Developed strong communication skills working with diverse student cohorts

TECHNICAL SKILLS & LANGUAGE

- **Software & Programming**
 - Visual Studio (C#/.NET) - Built custom Windows Forms applications for laboratory experiments (risk/ambiguity elicitation, BDM mechanism, complexity treatments)
 - MATLAB, R, STATA - Data analysis and econometric modelling
 - zTree, oTree - Familiar with standard platforms, but prefer custom programming for complex designs
- **Language** Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent), Japanese (basic), Thai (beginner)

REFERENCES

Professor John Hey
Department of Economics and Related Studies
University of York
John.Hey@york.ac.uk

Professor Yuan Ju
Department of Economics and Related Studies
University of York
Yuan.Ju@york.ac.uk

Dr Khushboo Surana
Department of Economics and Related Studies
University of York
khushboo.surana@york.ac.uk